building up from within the party for radical change.

To avoid becoming hostage to the vagaries of its allies, the BJP may launch another round of what experts call 'mergers and acquisitions' of MPs from other parties to boost its tally towards the halfway mark. Hence, the backdoor efforts to win the support of the DMK's Stalin in Tamil Nadu and the TMC's Mamata Banerjee in West Bengal, in the event that the TDP and JD(U) play truant. For Rahul and the Congress, this MOTN is a message that the party needs to consolidate its gains in the current Lok Sabha and narrow the yawning gap with the BJP so that the party emerges as the fulcrum of a credible alternative to the current dispensation. For Modi, it is back to battle stations. Given his past track record, adversity always brings out the best in him. In his Independence Day address, the PM told the nation, "The country is bound to become the third-largest economy during my third term, and I will work three times harder, at three times the speed, and with three times the scale so that the dreams we have for the nation are realised sooner." Modi seems determined to prove that he can not only survive the full term but also ensure rapid economic and social growth. That's the kind of can-do approach the nation needs. ■

33%

of the urban respondents reported higher levels of satisfaction with the NDA government's performance compared to 28% rural ones

Methodology

The India Today Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll was conducted by CVoter, a globally renowned name in the field of socio-economic research, between July 15, 2024, and August 10, 2024, interviewing 40,591 respondents covering all Lok Sabha segments across all states. In addition to these samples, an additional 95,872 interviews from CVoter's regular tracker data over the last 24 weeks were also analysed for the long-term trendline in calculating votes and seat projections. Thus, the opinion of a total of 136,463 respondents was considered for this MOTN report. The margin of error is +/- 3 percent at macro level and +/- 5 per cent at micro level of reporting, with 95 per cent confidence level.

Normally we use our tracking samples for projection analysis, making the previous MOTN exercise as our baseline. But this year was an election year and the baseline for this analysis is not January 26, 2024, when we calculated our last MOTN trendline. The new baseline starts on June 5, 2024, when the Lok Sabha results were declared. This is why we have used only the samples done after June 5, 2024, for all our projection calculations.

From May 2009 onwards, the CVoter Tracker has been carried out each week, 52 waves in a calendar year, in 11 national languages, across all states and UTs in India, with a target sample size of 60,000 each quarter. The average response rate is 55 per cent. Starting January 1, 2019, CVoter has been carrying the tracker daily, using the rollover sample of seven days for tracker analysis.

All these polls are based on a random probability sample as used in the globally standardised methodology, carried out by trained researchers across all geographic and demographic segments. This survey is based on CATI interviews of adult respondents across all segments. Standard RDD is used to draw random numbers covering all frequency series allocated to all operators across all telecom circles in India.

CVoter ensures proper representative analysis by statistical weighing of the data to make it representative of the local population as per the latest census figures. The data is weighted to the known census profile, including gender, age, education, income, religion, caste, urban/rural and vote recalls for the last Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. For the analytics, CVoter uses its proprietary algorithm to calculate the provincial and regional vote share based on the split-voter phenomenon.

CVoter follows the code of professional ethics and practices drafted by the World Association of Public Opinion Research and the official guidelines on opinion polling as instructed by the Press Council of India. ■